

Distant Reading

Simone Rebora

DISTANT READING

Conjectures on World Literature Moretti, Franco New Left Review; Jan 1, 2000; 1, ProQuest pg. 54

FRANCO MORETTI

CONJECTURES ON WORLD
LITERATURE

DISTANT READING

“[...] literary history will quickly become very different from what it is now: it will become ‘second hand’: a patchwork of other people’s research, *without a single direct textual reading*. Still ambitious, and actually even more so than before (world literature!); but the ambition is now directly proportional *to the distance from the text*: the more ambitious the project, the greater must the distance be”

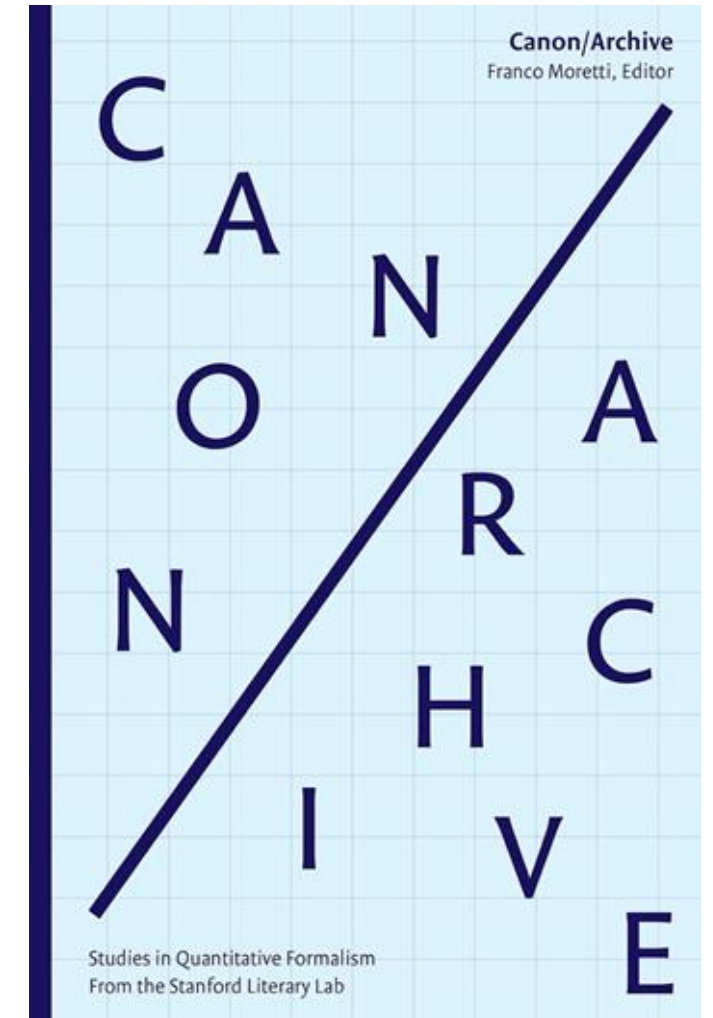
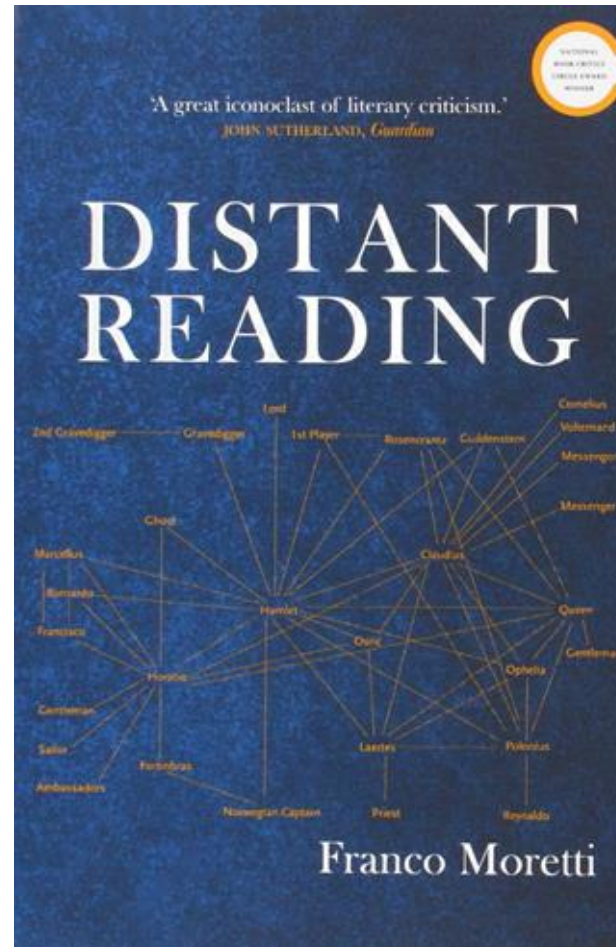
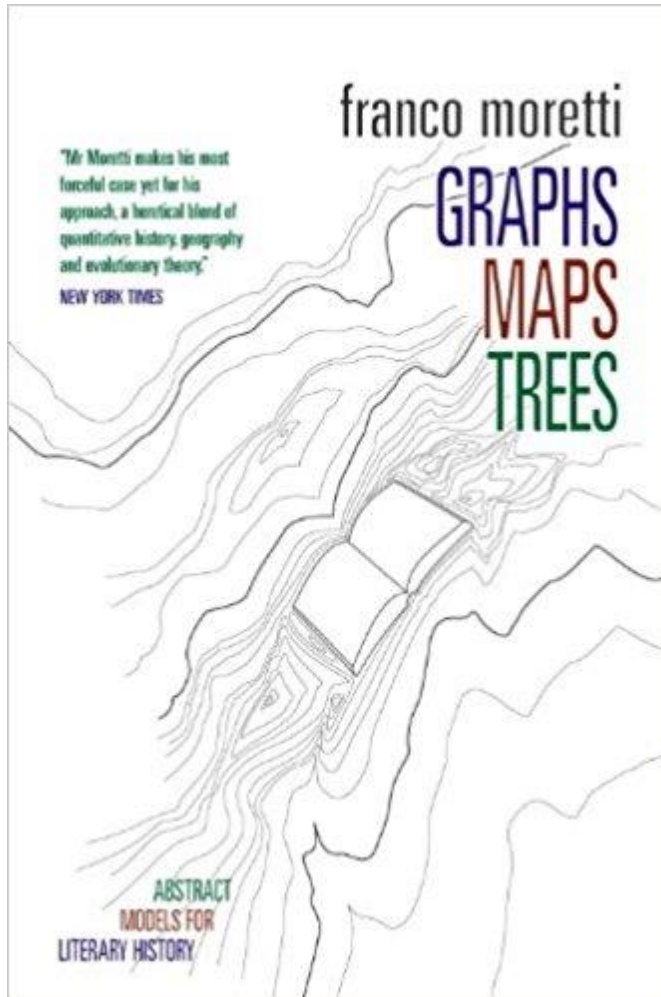
(Moretti, 2000)

DISTANT READING

“[...] a canon of two hundred novels, for example, sounds very large for nineteenth-century Britain (and is much larger than the current one), but is still less than one per cent of the novels that were actually published: twenty thousand, thirty, more, no one really knows—and close reading won’t help here, a novel a day every day of the year would take a century or so”

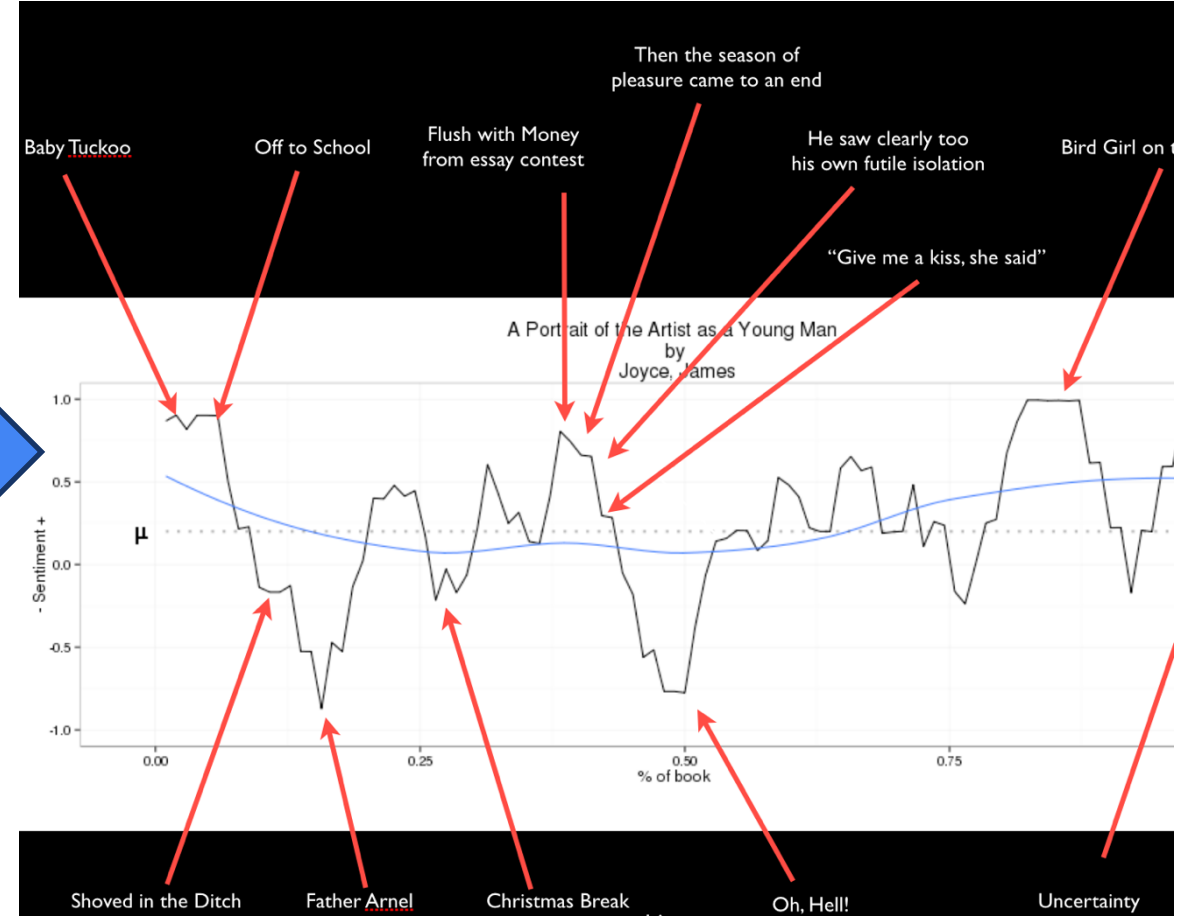
(Moretti, 2005)

DISTANT READING

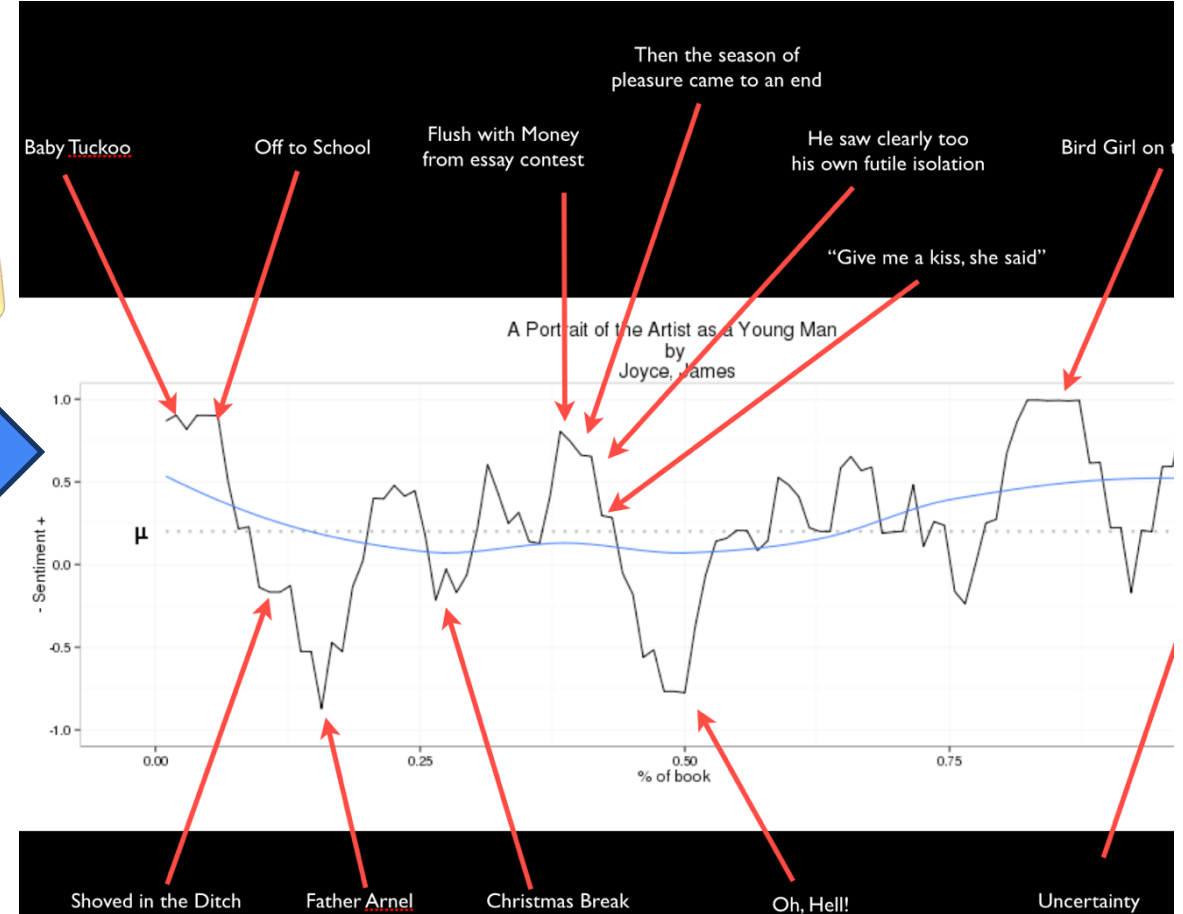


“Instead of reading texts in the traditional way – so-called close reading –, he invites to count, to graph and to map or, in other words, to visualize them” (Jänicke et al., 2015)

DISTANT READING



DISTANT READING



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(Jockers, 2014)

CRITICAL ASPECTS (IDEOLOGICAL)

L'IMPRONTA

CULTURA
UMANISTICA

LORENZO TOMASIN

E TECNOLOGIA

Carocci editore  Sfere extra

DIGITALE

«For the moment, a far more concrete risk than the improbable government of machines seems to concern the rise to power of people in the flesh perhaps less suitable than many machines to reason with the complexity and foresight that certain subjects would require. **That is, machine designers**» (Tomasin, 2017)

CRITICAL ASPECTS (PRACTICAL)

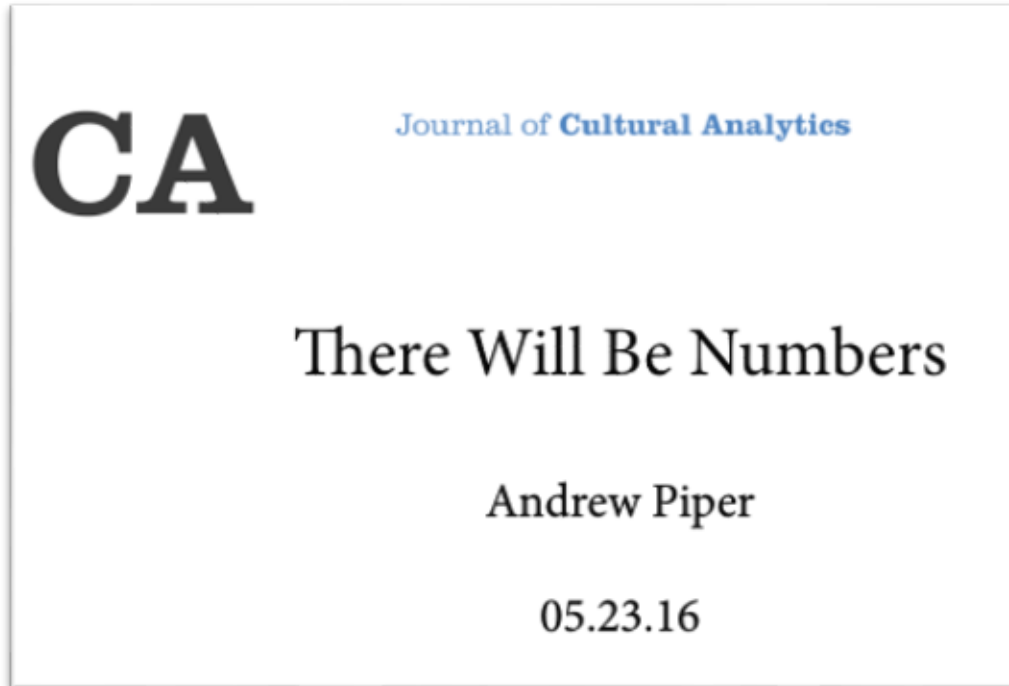
- Da took 14 representative computational studies (by authors such as Underwood and Jockers)
- ...and she repeated their analyses, showing errors and limitations
- but caution: this was just a “cherry picking”!

The Computational Case against
Computational Literary Studies

Nan Z. Da

Critical Inquiry 45 (Spring 2019)

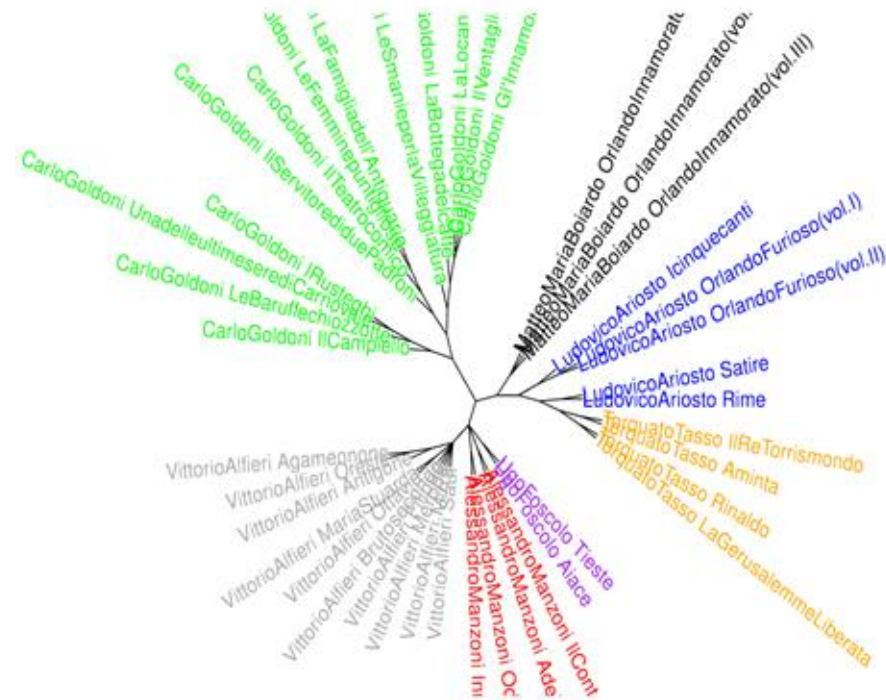
ADVANTAGES OF DISTANT READING



- The «double revolution» of computational methods in literary studies:
- From an «impressionistic» (and frequently opportunistic) choice of case studies
 - To their «representativeness»
 - From an «agonistic» criticism
 - To a «consensus-driven» criticism

...IN THIS COURSE

Stylometry

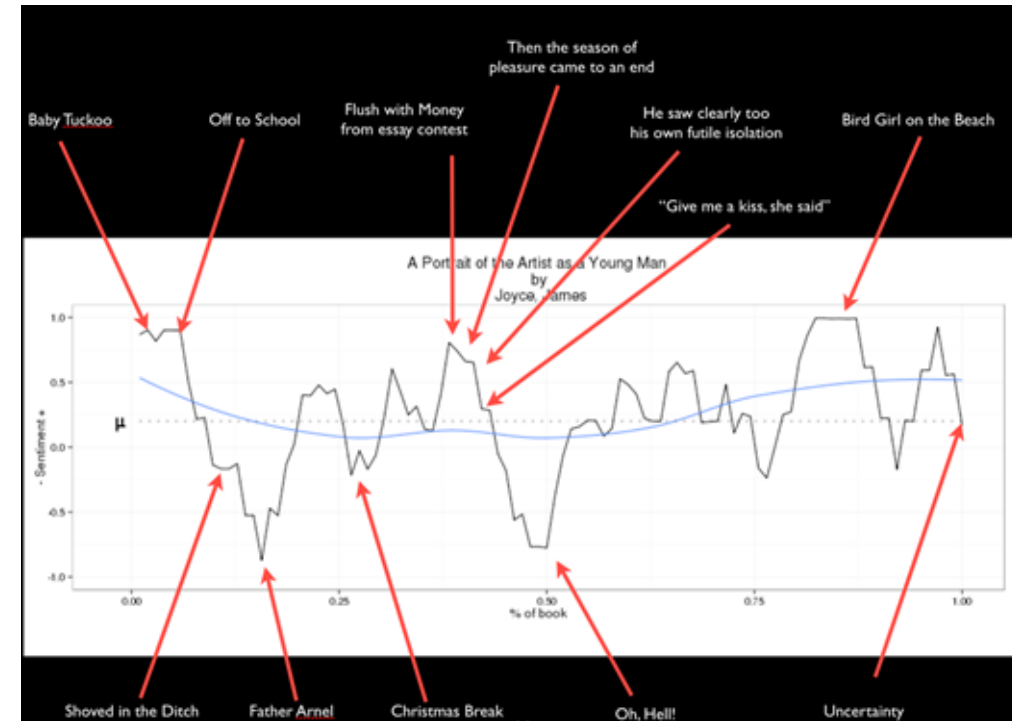


Topic Modeling



(Schöch, 2017)

Sentiment Analysis



(Jockers, 2014)